

Defect Classification and Rework Rules

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Defect classes

Every defect found at inline or final inspection is recorded in one of three classes. The class determines whether the lot can ship.

Critical defects make the garment unsafe or unsaleable and carry zero tolerance. These include a broken needle fragment detected in the garment, any sharp object, a missing or incorrect care label required by law, and wrong fibre composition on the label.

Major defects would cause a customer to reject or return the garment: broken or skipped stitching in a seam under stress, a measurement outside tolerance, a shade mismatch between panels of the same garment, an open seam, a missing button or a misaligned placket.

Minor defects are visible but would not usually cause a return: a loose thread end, a slightly uneven topstitch, a light surface mark that will wash out.

Common defects by construction

Polo and knit collar styles most often fail on collar and placket alignment and on shade variation between the body and the rib. Formal shirts fail most often on collar point symmetry and on sleeve placket construction. Fleece hoodies fail on drawcord length and on hood symmetry. Denim fails on leg twist and on indigo shade banding across the spread.

Rework rules

Minor defects are reworked on the line without stopping it. Major defects stop the affected operation until the root cause is identified, because a major defect found once in a sample is usually present across a batch.

Any garment reworked twice for the same defect is downgraded to seconds and removed from the order quantity. This matters for feasibility: a run with a 5 percent rework rate delivers 5 percent fewer units than the line output suggests, so the planned quantity must include the expected rework allowance.

Metal detection

Every garment passes through metal detection after finishing. A positive detection removes the garment and triggers a needle audit on the operation that produced it. Production on that operation stops until the broken needle is accounted for in full.